Steamy Atelier Chronicles: Smutember 2023

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Steamy Atelier Chronicles: Smutember 2023

by amaryllis_fae

Summary

A collection of fics written using the Gabenath Smutember 2023 prompts.

Notes

My first time doing one of these writing events. This was supposed to be done a few days ago but then life happened. I'll try to update when I can but there won't be any strict schedule. Enjoy!

Prompt list can be found here: https://www.tumblr.com/the-gabenath-smutfest/727104796957474816/the-gabenath-smutember-calendar-2023?source=share

Chapter 1: Elevator- Gabenath

Gabriel despised social events. There was a reason he preferred to keep to the confines of his mansion where he didn't have to be bothered by small talk and schmoozing social climbers vying for his attention was false niceties and flattery. But for all that he despised interacting with the Parisian high society, years of practice had made him adept at it.

Fashion week after-parties inevitably couldn't be avoided, no matter how trivial Gabriel believed them to be. Everyone was expected to be in attendance so his absence was sure to be noticed. The sole positive was that as the party was being held in function room of their hotel, there was a quick exit right there should the night become unbearable. All he had to do was endure long enough to do the rounds.

After countless of the same dull, monotonous gatherings Gabriel didn't think he could find anything new he could hate about them. Tonight managed to prove him wrong.

The flashing cameras, the clinking of champagne glasses and the incessant hum of polite conversation grated on his nerves as usual. The social climbers seemed to be more aggressive in their attempts to gain his attention as if vapid praise and compliments would earn them his favour. The majority of these came from younger designers and models who were only interested in what his name and brand could do for their careers.

Having Nathalie with him was a blessing. She could wordlessly read his demeanour, covertly changing the conversation's subject or averting a guest's focus elsewhere before he snapped. She was the only lifeline he could consistently rely on.

And he hasn't seen her in half an hour. It unnerves him.

He has long since tuned out of the petty gossip he'd been dragged into, though no one seems to mind that he isn't contributing. Nursing a flute of champagne, he observes the spectacle of decadently dressed guests mingling with a detached air.

His fingers thrum impatiently on his flute as his eyes systematically scan the vast room, searching for a glimpse of the red chiffon he'd managed to dress Nathalie in. It had taken weeks of persuading and bargaining until Nathalie had finally relented and allowed him to design her dress for the occasion. It had been the only part of the evening he'd looked forward to and it definitely hadn't been a let down.

Finally finding that dress amongst the crowd Gabriel is reminded of just how well it suits her. He can't help the swell of pride in his chest at the sight of her in once of his creations. The vibrant red fabric hugs her figure in all the right places, accentuating her slender frame and the delicate lace detailing adds just the right amount of elegance.

And then he notices the demeanour of the man she's talking to and the small proud smile is wiped from his face. The man is tall and impeccably dressed, exuding a certain charm that's hard to ignore. Not unusual to come across in the world of fashion where appearance is everything. What is unusual is the stranger's body language, the way he maintains eye

contact with Nathalie and how he's standing so close that he occasionally brushes Nathalie's upper arm indicates a level of familiarity that Gabriel finds disconcerting.

He doesn't like it one bit.

He's unable to tear his eyes away from the pair, too busy looking over the man and gleaning any information he can get. It only takes him a second of observation to notice that the stranger's eye line is directed straight towards Nathalie's cleavage. It's a miracle that Gabriel's glass doesn't shatter with how tightly he's gripping it.

She isn't visibly reacting to the man leering down at her and Gabriel can't tell if that's because she's being professional or if she hasn't noticed. Suddenly her skill at suppressing her every emotion seems more like a hinderance than a help. He doesn't even allow himself to contemplate the possibility that the advances are welcomed.

White hot jealousy grows with every second Gabriel stands there observing them, itching under his skin until it's unbearable, spurring him into action. Any concern of offending the small group of people surrounding him whose names he's already forgotten is furthest from him mind. He tears away from the conversation, striding with a sense of purpose towards them.

Heads turn as he brushes past him. He catches the tail end of a whisper about him here and there. They're easy to ignore when he had a clear goal in mind. With each step he takes, the clamour of the party seems to fade into the background.

"Nathalie, I've been looking for you," his tone is cordial but with a hint of possessiveness.

The man's eyebrows raise as Gabriel nonchalantly rests a hand on Nathalie's shoulder and a small feeling of triumph rises in his chest. His fingertips just barely press into her skin, just enough to send his message. *Mine.*

Gabriel's presence has an immediate effect as the stranger's friendly facade falters. Nathalie is slightly surprised at the contact but she plays it off well. She regains her composure, her eyes subtly acknowledging Gabriel's touch on her shoulder questioningly.

"Mr Agreste!" The man says, appearing a little stunned for a moment. "It's a pleasure to meet you." He extends a friendly hand towards the fashion designer, as if hadn't just been eyeing up Gabriel's personal assistant mere moments ago. He opens his mouth to continue talking but Gabriel is quick to interject. He doesn't want to spend any more time around this guy than is necessary.

Gabriel doesn't engage in small talk and, instead, gets straight to the point. "Nathalie, I'd like to introduce you to a few important contacts I've made tonight. We should catch up with them."

It's a blatant lie which he fully expects Nathalie to see straight through. He pointedly ignores the outstretched hand in front of him. Using the arm around her shoulder, Gabriel spins Nathalie around before either she or the man have a chance to speak. As he guides her away Gabriel knows what he's doing is unspeakably rude, the man hadn't even had an opportunity

to introduce himself, but all he feels is relief as he takes Nathalie further out of reach from the stranger.

They don’t head towards any of the heads that turn to their direction, silently asking for his attention. Instead he leads Nathalie to the function room exit, his hand not leaving her wrist for a second. She doesn't resist his pull but her posture stiffens slightly. Her mind is already in damage control mode, coming up with strategies to curb any gossip such a public exit will inevitably initiate.

“Want to explain what that was about?” Nathalie asks dryly as soon as the doors click closed behind them, her eyebrow quirks upwards questioningly.

Gabriel doesn’t answer, preferring to brood in silence. They might be physically out of the situation but he was still worked up. Nathalie didn’t push him any further.

Gabriel's grip on her arm tightens, betraying his unease. "I don't like the way he was looking at you,” he finally says as they wait for the elevator to arrive.

Nathalie's lips curl into a small, knowing smile. "Jealous, are we?" she teases, her voice tinged with amusement. Gabriel’s jaw tightens, realising he can’t argue against her. “Not that the thought isn’t appreciated, but we’ve discussed not showing our relationship in public. Leaving like this isn’t going to have a good look.”

It’s killing Nathalie that she can’t reach out and console him. She’s all too aware that they’re still in a public space and while Gabriel’s behaviour can be written off as being an eccentric millionaire hers cannot. Having anyone see that would make the problem ten times worse.

They enter the elevator in silence. Nathalie can practically feel Gabriel’s frustration simmering just beneath the surface. He’s never been very good at regulating his emotions when he’s this riled up.

The second that the metal doors ding shut, Gabriel grabs Nathalie by her forearms and push her into the wall. He moves so quickly that she barely has time to comprehend what’s happening before his lips crash into hers in a searing kiss.

It doesn’t take long for Nathalie to get over the initial shock and she’s quick to reciprocate. Cold metal presses into her back as her front is enveloped in his warmth. Gabriel’s hand, previously holding Nathalie’s arms in place, now cradles her face, deepening the kiss. It’s a passionate, possessive embrace, a reflection of the complex feelings surging between them.

Nathalie’s arms instinctively find their way around his neck, drawing him closer as the elevator starts its ascent. Her fingers dig into his silver hair, causing his head to dip down lower. The kiss is intense, fuelled by the unresolved tension simmering beneath the surface throughout the evening.

Gabriel breaks away for a moment, his breath coming in short, heated pants. Nathalie’s cheeks are already flushed pink which deepens in colour as she gazes into his intense eyes.

“I couldn’t stand watching it, the way his eyes were roaming all over you. I could feel exactly what he was thinking.”

“As I recall, it was you who insisted on dressing me up. You can’t be surprised that wearing a Gabriel original wouldn’t get me more attention.” Gabriel pouts.

“Well then maybe you’ll have to dress up in private, just for me.” He murmurs in her ear, his voice husky with desire. He leans in to steal another kiss, their lips meeting in a heated embrace. His hands slide down her back and cups her ass.

Gabriel eases her ass forward, while at the same time pressing into her slowly yet forcefully. Nathalie can’t help but gasp her crotch meets his bludge, delicious pressure right where she needs it the most. As the kiss grows more frantic and desperate, so does his thrusts, turning from light and teasing to frenzied and firm.

It’s addicting and she desperately wants more. She’s throbbing with need. Their clothes seem like such a nuisance and if it wan’t for a small voice in her head reminding her that they were still in a public place, she would have started pulling off clothes minutes ago.

Every bump against her clit has her mewling. She lifts a hand to his chest. She can feel his muscles flexing under her touch snd she notice that he grows even harder. The other has a vice-like grip on his shoulder, nails digging in and wrinkling the fabric.

He’s an equally unravelled mess as he no longer needs to hold back. His fingers are busy scrambling to every inch of her that they can reach. His mouth alternates between giving attention in her lips and neck, leaving a visual cacophony of bite marks and smudges of lipstick, the different shades of red seamlessly blending together.

And just when Gabriel has bunched up the length of Nathalie’s dress and wriggled his fingertips under the band of her underwear, the elevator comes to a jolting stop. Neither of the move in the seconds it takes for the doors to open, but luckily there isn’t anyone else on the top floor.

Gabriel audibly groans at the interruption, that anything would take his attention away from the woman in his arms. Nathalie is the first to react, attempting to pull away from Gabriel but he holds her tight.

“You’re going to get us caught,” she warns, her breathing is positively ragged.

Gabriel only grins at her, a wicked glint in his eye. In a swift movement, he scoops Nathalie up bridal style and is practically running down the halls with her in his arms as his prize.

A startled laugh escapes her lips. “Where are you going?”

“Somewhere I can have you all to myself,” Gabriel responds, somehow managing to slip the key card into their room door without dropping Nathalie.

Chapter 2: Time Travel- Gabenath

Chapter Summary

Gabriel stumbles across an alternate future where he ends up with Nathalie.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Victory is within Gabriel's grasp. He has all the tools he needs to bring his wife back and nothing can stop him. As he steps into the burrow, a surge of adrenaline courses through his veins, and, for once, fortune seems to favour him rather than those insufferable heroes.

Of course he has Nathalie to thank once again, his ever dependable assistant. It wasn't really a surprise, she'd been the brains behind most of the plans that had gotten him closest to victory, but he didn't know how he could have completely overlooked the power the rabbit miraculous could give him. In his hands is his only chance to save Emelie without hurting a single person. It's the best possible outcome they could have hoped for.

There must be hundreds, possibly thousands, of round time windows surrounding him from all manner of timelines. Finding one specific entry point would be like finding a needle in a haystack but Gabriel had made it this far. After constantly fighting and losing for the better part of a year he could summon the patience to persist a little while longer.

His eyes scan across the windows directly in front of him. The cluttered panorama was an imposing sight, a kaleidoscope of past, present and future events all presenting themselves before him. A couple of scenes he recognises from his own past, including a scene of a healthy Emilie helping toddler Adrien balance on her feet while she cradled his tiny hands to steady him which stabbed at Gabriel's heart.

The majority of the others showed people he wasn't familiar with, making it difficult to distinguish if they were past or present without obvious clues. Picking one circle at random, Gabriel places his hand up to the surface. The single still image reacts to his touch instantaneously and it changes into a blur of other time points, each moment lingering only long enough for his brain to vaguely register the contents before moving on.

He goes through a myriad of blurred figures, scouring each for a glimpse of that familiar shade of blonde hair and green eyes. Even when he did manage to spot Emilie and went back to survey it more closely, all of the moments were either from far before the idea of miraculous' was in their minds or after Adrien had been born. Even though disappointment stings every time it was the wrong point in time, there's also a sweet melancholy in relieving memories of happier times when their family was complete.

If he wasn't so focused on not missing a single image, he might have missed it altogether. It moved on so quickly that Gabriel isn't convinced it was even the first interpretation his brain made. Surely he must have have been confused by the colours bleeding into each other. Either way it threw his concentration off and removed his hand from the window, the display coming to a halt on a random image the second he ceased contact.

The logical choice would be to continue forward, towards his wife and the future they could have as soon as his search was complete. The subject of the image that startled him had certainly not been Emilie, that much he is convinced. Checking it more closely would get him no closer to his goal.

And yet, an inexplicable curiosity tugs his hand to the left side of the window. The movement is instinctual, his body has made the decision before his brain can catch up. A jolt of electricity shoots up his spine and his heartbeat stutters as he processes exactly what he's looking at. He's shocked into stillness until he sharply inhales.

The image his staring at is of Nathalie. It takes him a minute to recognise her as her hair isn't pinned back in its signature bun, rather it's loose and almost reaches the middle of her back. She starts moving once he stops on the image. However this powers work they seem to know he's choice in this moment.

She's sitting on a bed reading, not an unusual activity for him to catch her doing. But his line of sight isn't focused on her face or the book in her hands. The book is only slightly covering it, not nearly enough to obscure it from Gabriel's stunned eyes.

Nathalie is pregnant.

He visibly blanches, but he can't look away. His eyes are glued to the swell of her stomach. From the size he calculates she must be around five or six months along. A hand rests casually on the top of the bump, stroking it absentmindedly every now and then. It strikes him how beautiful she is.

Her expression is so contented that it takes Gabriel off guard. It's so starkly different to how he normally sees her, the way her entire face tenses when's she trying to solve a miraculous-related problem or the pain he sometimes catches glimpses of in her eyes before she can hide it away. He'd never considered the possibility that being a mother could be something that she wanted for herself.

There's far too many questions that bump ignites. When he's able to wrench his gaze away from her, it darts around the rest of the scene, searching for desperately needed context. He knows Nathalie hasn't been pregnant in the 15 years she's been his employee so this moment is probably from the future or an alternate timeline. The wrinkles that tug at the corner of her eyes back up this hypothesis.

He realises in a matter of seconds that the room is far too familiar to him. She's sitting in his bedroom, on his bed.

The discovery sends shockwaves through him. There's no chance of him moving on now. All thoughts of Emilie and his mission are dashed from his mind. He needs to know how this had

happened, if this was really his future or just something that could have been.

There had been moments in the past when his eyes had lingered on his assistant a few seconds too long where that what if question had popped up in his mind, but it was always promptly squashed. The need for the miraculous and his commitment to Emilie was too heavy for him to contemplate any other future.

But now that what if was staring him in the face and he couldn't look away. His eyes locked on Nathalie as she got up from the bed and walked over the the ensuite, a slight waddle to her walk.

The questions are eating away at him. Before he can overthink it, Gabriel pushes through the portal, consequences be damned. *He needs to know.*

As Gabriel stepped through the time portal and into his own bedroom, a sense of both familiarity and strangeness washed over him. The bedroom is mostly how he remembers it, but there's something slightly off. Some of the smaller trinkets have been changed, there's more photo frames for a start, but the room is giving off a warmer aura.

"I thought you'd be working late tonight again."

Nathalie's voice catches him off guard. Of course she's mistaken him for her Gabriel, his doppelgänger who's probably still downstairs in the atelier. He scrambles to come up with a plausible answer.

*"*Just a creative block I couldn't push through. I must have been distracted."

Nathalie's features light up as she steps closer. Just being in his presence appears to put her at ease, the slight tension in her shoulders visibly melting away. She reaches for him and lightly squeezes his arm in comfort.

"To be honest, it's been nice to see you actually taking more breaks."

She wraps her arms around his neck and pulls his head down for a kiss. There was no hesitation, no questioning pause in Nathalie's actions. She kisses him as if it is the most natural thing in the world, as if they have shared countless kisses before. Her level of boldness is surprising yet there's a sense comfort it brings, making the whole bizarre situation seem like it's right. Why should Gabriel question it when she's this sure?

It's a moment that is both dreamlike and yet undeniably real, and it leaves Gabriel momentarily breathless.

When she pulls back he tries to remind himself that this isn't his Nathalie. She isn't pregnant with *his* child. He doesn't belong here.

She's staring at him with pure affection. Even with her head lowered, her face is still so close to his that he can't help but study it. The way her lips part as she catches her breath and the gentle rise and fall of her chest stir something within Gabriel that he hadn't anticipated.

Despite his inner conflict, he doesn't pull away. Even though he knows he should. Even though this is beginning to feel dangerous.

His skin tingles when her fingers gently brush against his cheek. He feels the cold touch of her wedding bands. Something shifts in her expression, a glint of mischief in her eyes. She leans further into him, peering up at him through her eyelashes. "Since you now have a free evening, maybe you can help me with a problem that's been bothering me all day."

"Of course, what can I do my dear?" He imagines that's what he'd call her if she was really his wife, what she expects to hear from him. It only slightly bothers him that it doesn't feel unnatural to say.

Without saying a word, she takes his hand and he doesn't resist as she pulls it down, laying it flat over her protruding stomach and resting her hand on top. "Your baby has my hormones completely out of control." Her voice is deep with a sultry undertone.

She pushes his hand down the length of her stomach and in between her thighs, her legs parting automatically for him. Gabriel freezes, the world around him moving in slow motion. He should tell her to stop, to make up a reason to get out of this scenario. It would be so wrong for him to indulge, would cross over important morals. But he's supposed to be her husband, what could he say that would sound plausible?

It feels like an excuse, a lie that had been vital to tell himself before this moment. It's scary how much he wants to give into it.

Nathalie pulls him in for another kiss, halting his thought process and subsequently his inner turmoil. It's nothing like her first which was sweet and tender. It's a passionate, all-encompassing kiss, a kiss that erases doubts and blurs the lines between reality and fantasy. A second after they break for breath, she kisses him again. And again and again and again.

He's not sure exactly when, but somewhere between these kisses a decision is made. This would be his only opportunity to be with Nathalie like this, to experience what could have been, if things had panned out differently in his own timeline. No one would ever have to know it happened. This moment of indulgence, it would be his dirty little secret. He's hidden so much by this point, what's one more?

He's losing control. He can feel it slipping away from him by the second.

Gabriel curses his traitorous heart. It would be so much easier if this was mere lust but he can no longer deny the way Nathalie tugs at his heartstrings.

When his fingers fail to move on their own, Nathalie presses herself down, rubbing herself against his hand. He's shocked by how wet he can tell she is, even through two layers of clothing. She moans softly at the friction he provides and he feels her shudder under his touch. At her reaction, he instinctually moves his hand forward, the heel of his palm pressing further into her clit.

He wants more. He wants to touch every inch of her. He wants to taste her. He wants her to be his.

Nathalie groans loudly at the feel of Gabriel's hand cupping her most sensitive spot. Every inch of her is practically begging for his touch. But Gabriel doesn't want to rush. Now that he's made up his mind, he know this is a once in lifetime experience and he wants to savour every part of it.

Nathalie moves quickly, obviously eager to get going. Her fingers don't stay idle as he rubs her through her trousers. She makes quick work of turning his jacket, tie and shirt into one white pile on the floor. Her fingertips trailing down his chest are feather-light, almost tickling him. He closes his eyes and enjoys the sensation. The warmth of her breath on his skin is enough to make him gasp.

She brushes over his stomach and reaches his pants, causing an electric reaction. The movement triggers a reflex and his hips involuntarily jut forward, a deep groan reverberates in the back of his throat. Nathalie's eyes flick down to his pants for a second before meeting his gaze. He easily gets the message and his hands shoot straight towards his belt.

In the time it takes for Gabriel to take them off, Nathalie has already dealt with her clothes with practiced efficiency. The sight of her naked body causes his breath to catch in his throat. It takes all his willpower not to throw her onto the bed right there and then. With her pregnancy he knows he has to be gentle.

She kisses him with desperation, her hands running all over his body. Her swollen belly presses against him and his member which is throbbing at the contact. They're a tangle of limbs desperately grasping at each other as the stumble towards the bed. He breaks away for her mouth reluctantly, taking a step back so he can lie down, pulling Nathalie down on top of him. She straddles him and they fit together snugly, like she's made for him.

Gabriel's hands slide up her body and cup her breasts. They're slightly bigger from her pregnancy and fill his hands nicely. Her nipples harden under his touch and she moans softly, her eyes flitting shut for a moment when he runs his thumbs over the tips.

Squirming under his touch, Nathalie sifts in his lap, her wet pussy making contact with his cock. He doesn't bother stifling the resulting strangled sound he makes. Grinning playfully, she grinds down again, purposefully this time. The action makes him crazy with need.

"God you're gorgeous," he mutters under his breath but with her proximity Nathalie easily hears it. She opens her eyes and beams at him, dazzling lust shinning in her eyes. She kisses him again, tangling both hands into his blonde hair, thoroughly messing up its perfectly gelled style.

Gabriel takes the opportunity to grab his cock and position it at Nathalie's entrance. He runs the tip along the length of her pussy, her juices liberally coating him. He makes sure to pay special attention to her clit and earns a smothered whine. Nathalie pulls back, a thin string of saliva connecting them until she speaks.

"Don't you dare tease me." Her voice is breathless and urgent, but with enough of an edge that Gabriel can't help but chuckle at her.

"Anything for you."

Not needing any more encouragement, he slips inside of her with ease. He watches her face for any sign of discomfort but is met with a look so intense it could melt steel. She almost immediately throws her head back and cries out, as if a deep scratch has finally been itched.

After recovering from the initial high of finally being buried deep inside her, Gabriel establishes a consistent yet slow rhythm. His dick pulses and begs for him to go faster but he isn't going to risk hurting Nathalie. He isn't quite sure what she can handle while being pregnant.

"Faster. Gabriel, I'm not going to break," Nathalie huffs, annoyance evident in her tone. Gabriel isn't about to argue with her and he picks up the pace.

Her breasts bounce and jiggle with each of his upwards thrusts. He hits just the right spot inside Nathalie and her back arches, pushing her breasts closer to Gabriel's face. He doesn't have to lean forward much to capture her right nipple in his mouth. She whimpers as his teeth graze over her sensitive nipple.

A deep satisfaction like he hasn't known in years ripples through him. Nothing else matters except for the woman in front of him. She's absolutely addicting and he dives into her greedily. He's denied himself for so long, why shouldn't he indulge a little?

The feeling of her tight walls massaging his dick is enough on its own to drive him insane. The pressure is building inside him and he attempts to hold it on. In a desperate attempt for her to come before him, Gabriel drops his hand to Nathalie's crotch. His thumb rapidly undulates on her clit as pounds into the spot that makes her gasp the most. His efforts don't go unrewarded.

When he watches her orgasm with a scream so high-pitched he knows it must be the loudest sound he's heard come from his assistant. In that moment he knows that everything has changed. There is no way now that he can go back to his own timeline with his original goal intact. Not when he knows that this is a possibility. That Nathalie is a possibility. He can't take back the realisation that he wants Nathalie to be his future.

Somehow he knows it's that thought that brings him over the edge. He grips Nathalie's hips, pushing her down as far as she can possibly go as he comes. He mind turns blank and all logical thought is lost to him.

Completely exhausted, Nathalie slumps forward, her head burying into his neck. Her pants are long and laboured as she recovers. Gabriel strokes her back lovingly and plays with stray strands of her hair, twirling them around his fingers.

Suddenly, the bedroom door flies open and they both flinch at the sound. Nathalie's head whips up to face the intrusion.

"Nathalie? I heard you scre-" A familiar voice cuts through the air like a knife. This world's Gabriel stands at the entrance, his face twisted in a mix of horror and confusion.

Gabriel grips Nathalie more tightly. He's staring straight at his doppelgänger, challenging him to even try wrenching her away from him. Now that he's experienced this future with

Nathalie, he never wants to let her go again.

Chapter End Notes

Apparently I’m unable to write smut without complex emotional situations

Chapter 3: Cane- Hawknath

Chapter Summary

Gabriel learns about Nathalie's unusual reading habits and gets an idea to surprise her with.

Chapter Notes

We're just gonna pretend this wasn't sitting as a WIP on my desktop for 4 months

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“I’m not arguing with you about this Nathalie.” Gabriel says, his voice is stern and clearly conveying his concrete resolve.

He’d known Nathalie would be stubborn, especially with anything involving work. It’s what makes her such a good assistant, she won’t easily back down against a pushy client or business associate. Gabriel appreciates the skill less when it’s turned against him.

Nathalie purses her lips together with the faint ghost of a pout. She glares at him, eyes barely blinking and challenging him to even try continuing. Despite how frustrated he is, Gabriel can’t help but find her demeanour rather amusing.

“Do you have any idea how much more I’m supposed to get done today?”

Gabriel’s eyes narrow in retaliation. This is an issue he isn’t going to budge on. “I know for a fact that you’re practically only running on caffeine at this point. You’re going to get sick if you don’t take a break.”

Nathalie's brow furrows and for a brief moment, her challenging gaze softens in the face of Gabriel’s concern. "I'm capable of handling my workload, sir. It's not the first time we've had tight deadlines.”

Suppressing a chuckle at her stubbornness, Gabriel walks over to her side and pulls her in for a tender kiss. She melts into his side. With her defences lowered, he takes the opportunity to smoothly wrestle her tablet out of her hands.

“I’m supposed to be looking after you, remember? I can handle my own company for one afternoon.”

Nathalie’s resistance falters as she is momentarily lost in his warmth. Gabriel's touch, as always, had the power to melt her determination. She knows she should be annoyed that he’s figured out how to weaponise these stolen moments of intimacy, but she simply isn’t. How could she when he knows exactly how to make her feel so good.

Forgetting about their argument, Nathalie’s hands automatically wander to loosen Gabriel’s tie, only for his hands to capture her wrists. His tongue clicks in reproach.

“You’re supposed to be resting.”

Nathalie almost makes it out the door when Gabriel calls her back and takes her phone as well, ensuring she has no devices left and can’t return to her emails the second she’s out of Gabriel’s sight as he knows she would if given the chance.

She huffs in mock exasperation, but the smile tugging at the corners of her lips betrays her true feelings. "You're awfully bossy today, Mr. Agreste.”

“Stop stalling Nathalie.”

When Gabriel finally leaves the atelier the sun has already gone down. Adrien has already eaten dinner and his closed bedroom door indicates that Gabriel is unlikely to see him tonight.

He finds Nathalie sleeping in an armchair in one of the spare rooms. The question as to why she chose her old room rather than their shared room lingers in his mind. That is until he spied a novel lying face down in her lap, a hand still loosely gripping it and keeping the pages forcibly bent open at the last point she was reading.

Curiosity getting the best of him. He can’t help but pry the book away from her listless fingers. She doesn’t so much as stir as her novel is taken away from her.

The cover of the novel leaves Gabriel completely astonished. The cover art depicts a scantily clad woman being pulled into the embrace of a masked man, his chest unclothed and showing off rippled abs. The title reads Lustful Larceny.

It’s the complete opposite type of book that Gabriel expects Nathalie would read during her time off, if she were to read fiction at all. Perhaps it’s her dedication to her work that has her reading only factual books in her free time in his mind.

Intrigued by this new facet of Nathalie, Gabriel opens the book at the point her hand had saved it at and reads. Since starting their relationship, Gabriel was aware that Nathalie was no saint, but this level of erotica is something he never would have guessed.

He skims over the first few sentences on the page. The scene seems to be set sometime in the 1800s. It illustrates a masked bandit robbing a royal carriage. He’s in the process of pilfering a lavishly dressed lady who seems to be far too into he way he has her pinned to the side of the carriage, his sword pointed under her neck and lightly pressing her throat should she refuse to cooperate.

Thumbing through the pages, his eyes scan over the words as the scene quickly becomes far more explicit, in a cliched and risqué sort of way that reminds Gabriel of exactly why this genre is usually considered trashy.

Still, he can't pull himself away from it despite the cheesy one liners the characters spout throughout various stages of debauchery. He holds the book closer in intrigue and starts reading the words instead of just skimming over them.

That's the image that Nathalie wakes up to. Her eyes shoot open from sluggish tiredness to alarm as she spies Gabriel sitting on the edge of the bed and, more importantly, the book he's currently reading from. Her cheeks flush as she realises that the secret of her guilty pleasure has been discovered.

She makes a strangled squeak as she processes this new development, alerting Gabriel to the fact she's awake. He looks up from the book and smirks at her obvious apprehension. He doesn't say anything at first, choosing to revel in tense silence as he closes the novel over his thumb, saving his spot for later.

Seeing Nathalie embarrassed into silence is certainly a rare enough occurrence that Gabriel feels the need to make the most of it, but also to learn as much as he can from this discovery for future plans.

Having recovered enough to the point where Nathalie's gained most of her composure. The only things giving her away is the prominent flush on her face and the way she's focusing on any random object in the room to avoid making eye contact.

Perhaps Gabriel should be hurt that Nathalie felt the need to hide something as silly as this from him but the whole situation is so amusing that he can't possibly.

Obviously Nathalie isn't going to address the elephant in the room first. The knowledge that he currently holds the power in the room is addictive, possibly dangerous. The craving for more power is gripping him already.

Though that shouldn't be surprising. He's always been susceptible to power's temptation. He wouldn't have become Hawkmoth if that wasn't the case.

"Well this is a surprise," Gabriel finally breaks the silence. Wearing a sly grin, he lowers the book and raises an eyebrow. "Nathalie, I had no idea you had an interest in such… indulgent literature."

He lightly bounces the book in his hand to emphasise exactly what he's referring to. Nathalie's eyes briefly flick down to the book. She doesn't address it any further than that but it's more than alright.

All Gabriel needs to enact the plan currently forming in his head is for her to know that he knows. He'll make it so she can't ignore it.

"This isn't something I'd expect you to be reading," he elaborates. His anticipation for Nathalie's response is growing with every second. The direction of his plans depend on her

response.

“I didn’t think that was something you’d be interested in knowing.” Nathalie admits, though Gabriel isn’t sure how much of the statement is based in truth and what’s the excuse she’s scrambled to construct since she’s been caught.

Either way, her fate has been sealed in his mind. She turns her head away from him as she begins her answer.

Nathalie glances back at him, her expression a mix of irritation and resignation. "It's just a book, Gabriel. People read it for different reasons, everyone has their guilty pleasures. It doesn’t mean anything.” Her tone has the slightest degree of defence.

"Oh, I'm well aware," he replies, his tone cryptic. "But this particular choice tells me more than you might think."

He stands up from the bed and walks toward the door, making sure his polished white dress shoes click against the floor as loudly as possible so that Nathalie is aware of where he is, even if she isn’t looking at him.

It does not escape Nathalie’s notice that he’s taken her book with him.

Not a word about the trashy novel was said from either of them for the rest of the week. Nathalie was a little suspicious when Gabriel didn’t press any more questions about the subject, but she didn’t want to be the first person to bring it up.

If they had both silently agreed to pretend it didn’t happen, then that was alright with her.

Except that he still has her book. A fact that she can’t shake out of her head no matter how hard she tries.

As the weekend approached, Gabriel seems more preoccupied than usual. Nathalie notices the way he steals glances at her, a mischievous twinkle in his eye that makes her uneasy but in a strangely excited way. There’s a persistent feeling that he’s up to something, and it’s keeping her on edge.

She’s no longer able to completely focus on her work, her focus sliding away from the email she’s supposed to be composing as Gabriel walks away from his podium and leaves the atelier without a word.

He leaves the door open and Nathalie assumes he must be doing something trivial and will be back in a few minutes. Then she hears their bedroom door click close from upstairs.

10 minutes pass and the rest of mansion has fallen into silence save for the gentle clacking of Nathalie’s keyboard.

10 turns to 15 minutes.

And then 20.

Curiosity nags at Nathalie. She's normally fine-tuned to every facet of Gabriel's schedule, and is the first person to know when a Hawkmoth related deviance is required. This mysterious disappearance has thrown her off considerably. It has to be a culmination of his strange behaviour today.

He was up to something and Nathalie didn't appreciate being kept out of the loop.

Convincing herself that keeping Gabriel on schedule is definitely part of her job description, Nathalie pushes away from her desk and makes her way upstairs. Nothing sounds out of the ordinary, though there is no reply to her knocking at their bedroom door.

With no obvious clues for her to decipher, Nathalie is left completely unsure what she'll be met with when she pushes it open.

Hawkmoth smirking deviously at her is a scenario Nathalie hadn't been close to what she had been anticipating.

"What's going on Gabriel?" Nathalie asks, her features scrunched up in confusion. She barely manages a few steps into the room before Gabriel moves.

In a second he's behind the assistant, his cane held in both hands horizontally in in front of her, effectively stopping her from moving away. It only takes a slow yet forceful pull on the cane for it to make contact with her hips drag her backwards. He doesn't stop until her back is pressed against his front.

Nathalie's heart races at the unexpected proximity. She's acutely aware of his breath on the back of her neck and the firm grip of his hands on the cane. With the slightest tilt of Hawkmoth's head, his lips are grazing over the soft skin on the back of her neck.

"You're not leaving this room until I get what I want," the villain growls into her ear. His voice has dropped to an octave lower than she's used to, the gravelly texture sends shivers down her spine.

The threat has the desired effect and Hawkmoth grins to himself when he hears her gulp. Using his emphatic powers, he can already sense her surprise morphing into excitement, bordering on lust.

He wonders if she's already starting to get wet. If all goes to plan he'll have her absolutely sopping in no time.

Lazily he grinds into her ass, ensuring that she knows exactly how hard he is while simultaneously nuzzling the crook of her neck.

"And what is it that you want, Hawkmoth?" Nathalie attempts to ask as calmly as possible but her breath hitches, obviously affected as she tries to play into the role-play he has going on here. She can guess where he got the inspiration from.

A flash of satisfaction shoots through him at the sound of his supervillain name. Hawkmoth's response is to reach around and unbutton her blazer and the top few buttons of her blouse so

that her lacy black bra is revealed. He'd never been more glad that the turtle necks had become a more rare occurrence since they'd started dating.

"I want you to understand that all of this," Hawkmoth grabs one of her boobs through her bra for extra effect, "is mine."

Nathalie's body arches in response to his firm grip, driving her ass further against his erection. The fabric of her bra is thin enough that Hawkmoth can play with her nipple through it, giving it a couple sharp pinches as he toys with her.

After groping around her most sensitive parts for a few minutes, Hawkmoth abruptly whirls slams her against the closed door, pointing the end of his cane under her neck in reference to the trashy novel he'd caught her reading. Now that he can properly see all of her, she looks quite disheveled, his actions clearly already having a elicited the intended effects.

It makes for quite the picture, Nathalie pinned against the wall, lightly panting with her blouse pulled open, wisps of hair escaping her bobby pins and her thighs subtly pressing together. For the moment he's content with simply watching her unravel, burning the image into his brain.

Tilting his cane up so that it's under her chin, forcing her to lift her head and look him in the eye, Hawkmoth grins like a wolf about to pounce on his prey. Her pupils are blown and her quick breaths push her boobs together perfectly. He knows that he as her right where he wants her.

Her eyes flutter closed, suddenly overwhelmed by the growing need building inside her. "Please," her voice cracks as she begs.

Hawkmoth chuckles darkly. "My, my, enjoying being handled so roughly are we Miss Sancoeur? Aren't you just full of surprises."

Nathalie squirms under his appraisal, her eyes squeezing tighter from embarrassment.

"What exactly is it that you want?"

"Touch me," Nathalie finally says after a pause.

A gloved hand strokes her hair gently, savouring the way she trembles with anticipation. "You're going to have to be more specific than that," he says, his tone verging on being condescending.

In a bold move, Nathalie takes hold of his cane and carefully pushes it down. Curious as to where she's going with this, Hawkmoth allows it and doesn't resist. She continues until the cane is level with her crotch, the tip making the barest of contact with her clothed pussy.

Hawkmoth's eyes widen at her brazenness and he licks his lips as she's given him a thrilling idea. He pushes his cane forward, just enough to put pressure on her clit. She wriggles her hips, impulsively searching for more friction.

“Is that what you wanted?” Hawkmoth asks innocently, knowing that it isn’t nearly enough stimulation for her to gain any relief.

As expected, she shakes her head. “No, I need more.”

“More what?” He asks, the tip is his cane moving in slow, tantalising circles. “Don’t start getting greedy now.”

Her patience growing thin, Nathalie abruptly pushes forward and reaches out, either to grab Hawkmoth or the cane tormenting her he isn’t sure. He never finds out as he immediately moves away from her, withdrawing the cane and the pleasure it gave.

“Uh uh uh, that isn’t how this works,” he tuts disapprovingly like a parent scolding a misbehaving child. “I thought’d we’d established that I’m the one in charge here Miss Sancoeur.”

A glimmer of aggravation crosses her brow but she drops her arms and it vanishes quickly. She had always been a quick learner and clearly she wasn’t going to get anything she wanted without complying.

Instead of replacing the cane back to its previous position, Hawkmoth grasps the rounded handle and twists it, allowing the short hidden blade inside to be unsheathed. Before Nathalie has a chance to react, he slices with expert precision and the material of her pants and panties fall to the floor in ribbons.

She opens her mouth to gasp in surprise or shout words of protest at the destruction but Hawkmoth moves too quickly. He pins her back against the door, his mouth pouncing on hers in a fiery exchange. She can’t help moaning into his mouth, her body betraying her as he takes over her senses and she is completely turned on by the sudden turn of events.

“I shouldn’t be surprised, only naughty girls would want to fuck a supervillain. That’s what you’ve been fantasising about isn’t it.” Hawkmoth says with a knowing smile. It isn’t phrased as a question. “Are you going to behave now?”

Nathalie nods while wiping away the saliva dripping from her bottom lip and inadvertently smudging her lipstick even more in the process.

“Good, now where were we?”

The cane is back between her legs, only now there’s no barrier between it and her dripping slit. He traces the outline of it with the tip. Of course she’s as wet as he’s imagined she would be. The evidence of her arousal does wonders for his ego.

She lets out a shaking breath at the sensation of the cool tip running over her. She glances down in wonder at the cane moving against her, just missing the spots she wants it to brush over the most. It’s already coated liberally in her slick and glistening in the light.

And then all at once, deciding the foreplay is well and truly over, he pushes it inside, the first few inches spreading her open. Her body jerks at the sudden intrusion which only results in it

slipping a little deeper in.

“Fuck!” she gasps, her eyes widening. She’s so wet that the cane glides in and out of her with ease. Hawkmoth is content to watch as he fucks her with the cane, his hand on her hip to offer support and keep her steady.

There’s a sharp edge in his eyes that Nathalie can’t tear her gaze away from. He’s watching her with a barely contained hunger that makes her knees weak. If Hawkmoth hadn’t been pinning her to the wall by gripping her waist, she was sure she would have sunk down to the ground by now.

She knows she must look like an absolute mess. Her bobby pins have no doubt loosened from all the movement and the way he’s angling his cane to hit that sweet spot inside her has her positively drooling. If she’d glanced a reflection of herself in her current state, there’s no doubt in her mind that she’d be absolutely mortified. She never lost this much control.

But there was no mirror and in that moment her thoughts were consumed wholly on the man giving her this much pleasure.

Just before the sensation of him thrusting the object becomes too overwhelming, she’s sent over the blissful edge, She squirts hard when she comes, her juices flowing down the length of the cane and leaving sticking trails in their wake.

The experience is too much for her body to endure and she slumps against the wall, drunk on endorphins. Hawkmoth carefully gathers her up in him arms and cradles her limp form. With a flash he drops his magical transformation and she snuggles in closer to his chest.

She peers up at him through satisfied eyes

“Was that too much?” He asks, suddenly a little nervous for her reaction. It had been a bold move springing such a scenario on her without warning and though she appeared to have enjoyed it, he couldn’t help but seek reassurance.

“It was perfect,” Nathalie assuaged his anxiety and pulled his face closer for a tender kiss.

“I should let you read my books more often.”

Chapter End Notes

Is Nathalie reading trashy erotica probably OOC? Yes.
Do I head cannon it anyway? Absolutely.

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